

Monitoring and Operations Guide

CloudWatch, ECS, ALB, DocumentDB and runbooks

Flipkart Clone Microservices Workspace

Monitoring and Operations Guide

This guide explains how to monitor the Flipkart Clone locally and on AWS after deployment.

It covers:

- Local Docker monitoring
- ECS service monitoring
- CloudWatch logs and metrics
- ALB and target group health
- DocumentDB monitoring
- CloudWatch dashboards
- CloudWatch alarms
- Logs Insights queries
- Incident troubleshooting runbooks
- Daily and weekly operations checklist

PART 1: Monitoring Locally with Docker

Check Container Status

```
cd /home/user/flipkart-clone
docker compose ps
```

All services should show running or healthy.

View All Logs

```
docker compose logs -f
```

View One Service Log

```
docker compose logs -f api-gateway
```

Other examples:

```
docker compose logs -f product-service
docker compose logs -f user-service
docker compose logs -f mongodb
```

Check Health Endpoints

Service	Local Health URL
API Gateway	http://localhost:3000/health
User Service	http://localhost:3001/health
Product Service	http://localhost:3002/health
Cart Service	http://localhost:3003/health
Order Service	http://localhost:3004/health
Payment Service	http://localhost:3005/health
Notification Service	http://localhost:3006/health
Frontend	http://localhost:8080/healthz

Test quickly:

```
curl http://localhost:3000/health
curl http://localhost:3000/api/products?limit=3
```

Local Smoke Test

```
./scripts/smoke-test.sh
```

PART 2: AWS Monitoring Overview

Production monitoring should include these layers:

Layer	AWS Service
Container logs	CloudWatch Logs
CPU and memory	ECS CloudWatch Metrics
Request/latency/5XX	Application Load Balancer Metrics
Database	DocumentDB Metrics
Service health	ECS Service Events and Target Groups
Dashboards	CloudWatch Dashboards
Alerts	CloudWatch Alarms + SNS
Tracing	AWS X-Ray optional
Security traffic	WAF logs optional
Cost	AWS Budgets and Cost Explorer

PART 3: ECS Service Monitoring

Where to Check ECS Health

1. Open AWS Console.
2. Go to **ECS**.
3. Open cluster: `flipkart-cluster`.
4. Open **Services** tab.
5. Check each service:
 - `frontend-service`
 - `api-gateway-service`
 - `user-service`
 - `product-service`
 - `cart-service`
 - `order-service`
 - `payment-service`
 - `notification-service`

What Healthy Looks Like

For each service:

Field	Healthy Value
Desired tasks	1 or 2 depending setup
Running tasks	Same as desired
Pending tasks	0
Failed deployments	0
Latest deployment	Completed or steady state

ECS Service Events

Open each ECS service and check **Events**.

Important error messages:

Error	Meaning
<code>CannotPullContainerError</code>	ECR image, tag, or IAM issue
<code>Essential container exited</code>	App crashed after startup
<code>Health checks failed</code>	ALB or app health endpoint issue
<code>ResourceInitializationError</code>	Secrets/logs/network issue
<code>Cannot resolve host</code>	Cloud Map or DNS issue

PART 4: CloudWatch Logs

Recommended Log Groups

Create or confirm these log groups:

```
/ecs/flipkart-api-gateway
/ecs/flipkart-user-service
/ecs/flipkart-product-service
/ecs/flipkart-cart-service
/ecs/flipkart-order-service
/ecs/flipkart-payment-service
/ecs/flipkart-notification-service
/ecs/flipkart-frontend
```

Set Log Retention

For development:

7 days

For production:

30 to 90 days

Steps:

1. Open **CloudWatch**.
2. Go to **Logs** → **Log groups**.
3. Select log group.
4. Click **Actions** → **Edit retention setting**.
5. Choose retention period.

Logs Insights Queries

Find Errors

```
fields @timestamp, @message
| filter @message like /ERROR|Error|error|failed|Failed/
| sort @timestamp desc
| limit 100
```

API Gateway 502 or Proxy Problems

```
fields @timestamp, @message
| filter @message like /Proxy error|Bad gateway|ECONNREFUSED|ETIMEDOUT/
| sort @timestamp desc
| limit 100
```

MongoDB Connection Problems

```
fields @timestamp, @message
| filter @message like /MongoDB|Mongoose|connection|ECONNREFUSED|authentication failed/
| sort @timestamp desc
| limit 100
```

Authentication Problems

```
fields @timestamp, @message
| filter @message like /Invalid token|Authentication|JWT|401/
| sort @timestamp desc
| limit 100
```

Slow Requests if Logs Include Timing

```
fields @timestamp, @message
| filter @message like /response time|duration|slow/
| sort @timestamp desc
| limit 50
```

PART 5: Application Load Balancer Monitoring

Where to Check

1. Go to **EC2**.
2. Click **Load Balancers**.
3. Select `flipkart-alb`.
4. Check tabs:
 - Monitoring
 - Listeners
 - Security
 - Target groups

Important ALB Metrics

Metric	Watch For
RequestCount	Traffic volume
TargetResponseTime	API/frontend latency
HTTPCode_ELB_5XX_Count	Load balancer errors
HTTPCode_Target_5XX_Count	App/service errors
HTTPCode_Target_4XX_Count	Bad requests/auth errors
HealthyHostCount	Healthy ECS tasks
UnHealthyHostCount	Unhealthy ECS tasks

Recommended ALB Alarm Thresholds

Alarm	Threshold
ALB 5XX	> 10 in 5 minutes
Target 5XX	> 20 in 5 minutes
Response time	> 2 seconds for 5 minutes
Unhealthy targets	> 0 for 2 periods

Target Group Health

Open **EC2** → **Target Groups**:

- `flipkart-api-tg`
- `flipkart-frontend-tg`

Targets should be **healthy**.

If unhealthy, check:

- Container port mapping
- Health check path

- Security group from ALB to service
- ECS task logs
- App is listening on correct port

PART 6: DocumentDB Monitoring

Open **DocumentDB** → `flipkart-docdb-cluster` → **Monitoring**.

Key Metrics

Metric	Meaning	Alert When
CPUUtilization	Database CPU	> 75-80%
DatabaseConnections	Active connections	Sudden spikes or near max
FreeableMemory	Available memory	Very low for sustained period
ReadThroughput	Read traffic	Unexpected spikes
WriteThroughput	Write traffic	Unexpected spikes
ReadLatency	Read delay	Increasing over baseline
WriteLatency	Write delay	Increasing over baseline
DiskQueueDepth	Disk pressure	Sustained high value

Common DocumentDB Problems

Too Many Connections

Fix:

- Use connection pooling.
- Ensure each service creates one Mongoose connection, not one per request.
- Scale database instance if needed.

Slow Product Search

Fix:

- Add indexes.
- Cache frequent reads in Redis.
- Avoid unbounded queries.

Authentication Failed

Fix:

- Verify username/password.
- Check Secrets Manager value.
- Recreate ECS task with updated secret.

PART 7: CloudWatch Dashboard Setup

Create dashboard:

1. Open **CloudWatch**.
2. Go to **Dashboards**.
3. Click **Create dashboard**.
4. Name: Flipkart-Monitoring.

Recommended Widgets

ECS CPU Widget

Metrics:

ECS → ClusterName, ServiceName → CPUUtilization

Include all services.

ECS Memory Widget

Metrics:

ECS → ClusterName, ServiceName → MemoryUtilization

ALB Traffic Widget

Metrics:

ApplicationELB → RequestCount
ApplicationELB → TargetResponseTime
ApplicationELB → HTTPCode_Target_5XX_Count
ApplicationELB → HTTPCode_ELB_5XX_Count

Target Health Widget

Metrics:

HealthyHostCount
UnHealthyHostCount

DocumentDB Widget

Metrics:

CPUUtilization
DatabaseConnections
FreeableMemory
ReadLatency
WriteLatency

PART 8: CloudWatch Alarms

Create SNS topic first:

flipkart-alerts

Subscribe your email and confirm the email subscription.

Recommended Alarms

Alarm Name	Metric	Condition
API-Gateway-High-CPU	ECS CPU	> 80% for 5 min
Product-Service-High-Memory	ECS Memory	> 85% for 5 min
ALB-Target-5XX-High	Target 5XX	> 20 in 5 min
ALB-Unhealthy-Targets	UnHealthyHostCount	> 0 for 2 periods
DocumentDB-High-CPU	DocDB CPU	> 80% for 10 min
DocumentDB-Low-Memory	FreeableMemory	Below safe baseline
CloudWatch-Log-Errors	Metric filter	Error count > threshold

Create Metric Filter for Errors

1. Open a CloudWatch log group.
2. Click **Metric filters**.
3. Create filter pattern:

?ERROR ?Error ?error ?failed ?Failed

4. Create metric namespace:

FlipkartApp

5. Metric name:

ServiceErrorCount

6. Create alarm on this metric.

PART 9: Deployment Monitoring

When deploying a new version:

1. Open ECS service.
2. Click **Deployments and events**.
3. Watch new tasks start.
4. Confirm old tasks drain.
5. Confirm target groups become healthy.
6. Watch CloudWatch logs.
7. Test health endpoints.
8. Test frontend in browser.

Deployment Verification Commands

From your local machine:

```
curl http://ALB_DNS_NAME/api/health  
curl http://ALB_DNS_NAME/api/products?limit=3
```

If HTTPS/domain is configured:

```
curl https://yourdomain.com/api/health  
curl https://yourdomain.com/api/products?limit=3
```

PART 10: Incident Runbooks

Runbook A: Frontend Not Opening

Check in order:

1. ALB DNS opens or not.
2. Frontend target group healthy.
3. Frontend ECS tasks running.
4. Frontend service logs.
5. Security group allows ALB to frontend port 80.
6. Nginx health endpoint `/healthz`.
7. Browser console errors.

Runbook B: API Returns 502

Check:

1. API target group health.
2. API Gateway ECS tasks running.
3. API Gateway logs.
4. API Gateway env vars point to correct Cloud Map names.
5. Backend services are running.
6. Security groups allow API Gateway to services.
7. Cloud Map DNS namespace is correct.

Runbook C: Login/Register Fails

Check:

1. User service logs.
2. DocumentDB connectivity.
3. JWT secret present.
4. MongoDB URI has correct database name.
5. API request body is valid JSON.
6. User collection has unique email index.

Runbook D: Products Not Showing

Check:

1. Product service running.
2. Product service logs.
3. Product database has seeded products.

4. Product route is `/api/products`.
5. Frontend API base URL is correct.

If database is empty, seed products locally before image build or create an admin seed task.

Runbook E: Cart Fails

Check:

1. Cart service logs.
2. Product service reachable from cart service.
3. `PRODUCT_SERVICE_URL` env var.
4. JWT token is present in request.
5. User ID matches logged-in user.

Runbook F: Order Checkout Fails

Check:

1. Order service logs.
2. Cart has items.
3. Cart service reachable from order service.
4. Notification service reachable.
5. Payment service logs.
6. DocumentDB connection for orders and payments.

PART 11: Cost Monitoring

Use:

- AWS Budgets
- Cost Explorer
- CloudWatch log retention
- Tags

Recommended tags:

```
Project=FlipkartClone
Environment=Dev or Prod
Owner=YourName
Service=api-gateway or user-service etc.
```

High-cost areas to watch:

Service	Why Cost Rises
NAT Gateway	Hourly cost and data transfer
DocumentDB	Instance hours and backups
CloudWatch Logs	High log ingestion and long retention
Fargate	Too many tasks or large CPU/memory
WAF	Paid managed rules or high request volume
DataDog	Per-host/APM pricing

PART 12: Daily Operations Checklist

Do this daily in production:

- ☐ Check ECS services all running.
- ☐ Check ALB target groups healthy.
- ☐ Check CloudWatch alarms state.
- ☐ Review last 24 hours error logs.
- ☐ Check DocumentDB CPU and connections.
- ☐ Check deployment events if any release happened.
- ☐ Check AWS Budget status.

PART 13: Weekly Operations Checklist

Do this weekly:

- ☐ Review CloudWatch dashboard trends.
- ☐ Review slow endpoints and high latency.
- ☐ Confirm backups are working.
- ☐ Check ECR old image cleanup policy.
- ☐ Check IAM users and keys.
- ☐ Rotate secrets if needed.
- ☐ Review WAF blocked requests.
- ☐ Review Cost Explorer by service.
- ☐ Confirm log retention settings.

PART 14: Production Monitoring Minimum Setup

If you want a minimum production setup, configure these at least:

1. ECS Container Insights.
2. CloudWatch log groups for every service.
3. ALB 5XX alarm.
4. ALB unhealthy target alarm.
5. ECS CPU and memory alarms.
6. DocumentDB CPU and connection alarms.
7. SNS email alert topic.
8. AWS Budget alert.
9. CloudWatch dashboard.

This gives enough visibility to operate the application safely.